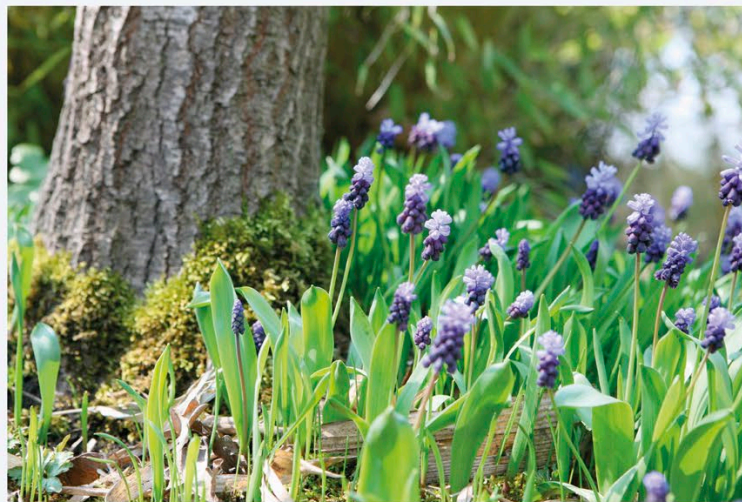


PLANTING YEAR

Gardens are like stage sets, with a change of scenery every few weeks helping to maintain the audience's interest. To put on this show, remember that while evergreens offer year-round color, they can't compete with the fleeting beauty of a tree in blossom or the unfurling petals of a rose in summer.

To create a garden that evolves month by month, you need to plan ahead. Punctuate boundaries and borders with trees and shrubs that produce different effects as the seasons turn, with flowers in spring and summer, followed by fiery foliage and berries in fall. Dress up these structural plants with climbers, such as clematis, that prolong their interest, and weave into your scheme a variety of early, mid-, and late-flowering perennials for a kaleidoscope of color. In fall, plant a range of spring bulbs in any gaps in your borders. These will provide a bright burst of flowers as winter fades.



Early to mid-spring Fall-planted bulbs, such as crocuses, grape hyacinths, and daffodils, together with early-flowering shrubs, including camellias, provide a blaze of color from early to mid-spring.



Late spring Bridge the gap between spring and summer with late-flowering tulips and alliums; clematis and shrubs, including New Jersey tea and lilacs; and perennials, such as bleeding heart and columbine.



Summer The choice of summer flowers is countless and includes every color, size, and shape imaginable. Place plants that perform early, such as roses, alongside late bloomers, like dahlias, to sustain the performance.



Fall As summer flowers start to fade, fall brings its own treasure trove of color and excitement. Flaming foliage is the main attraction, but also find a place for berried shrubs, grasses, and late flowers, such as asters.



Winter Choices dwindle as temperatures drop, but winter is still full of surprises. Flowers and bulbs, including snowdrops, brave the cold, and shrubs with evergreen leaves or bright stems, such as twig dogwood, also add color.